Assignment 1

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Lab Class P1

Good User Interface - Github “Danger Zone” Modal

Objective: Provide a centralized administrative dashboard where owners can manage repository configuration and settings, including collaborators, access keys, permissions, and permanent codebase deletion.

Good aspects:

- **Segmentation and Spatial Framing**: The interface doesn’t mix high risk operations with routine configurations options. Rather, Github isolates all this tasks in a dedicated block named “Danger Zone”
- **Safeguards**: In order for an user to delete a repository, a second modal is triggered that forces the user to manually input the name of the repo before the final action button shows up.

Why:

- **Color Exclusivity:** They didn’t reinvent the wheel and used for the general interface neutral greys and dark blue, saving the bold reds solely for actions in the “Delete the entire Repository” and other destructive endpoints, which serves as a pre-warning.
- **Visual State Lock:** Until the exact repository name is typed in the text box, the button remains greyed and non-interactive. This transition enables the user to visualize the moment the destructive capability is unlocked.

Bad User Interface - Restroom Identification

Objective: Signalize instantly which door corresponds to its designed restroom from a distance, enabling a fast decision from the user.

Bad aspects:

- **Replacement of standard icons:** Replacing the standard idea of human silhouettes icons with abstract, minimalist and ambiguous visuals.
- **Ambiguity and High Visual Issues:** Signs that prioritize artistic style often rely on subtle visual differences that cannot be parsed reliably in worsened condition (e.g. low lighting, seeing from an angle at a distance and so on)

Why its bad:

- **Fails Universal Accessibility -** Abstract icons break language and cultural barriers. Something as simple as a Restroom sign shouldn’t confuse international tourists, children, young and old adults, and individuals with visual or cognitive impairments

- **Inappropriate Cognitive load:** Wayfinding is a utility interface meant to be parsed in a short amount of time with almost no conscient thoughts, even more in moments where nature calls. Forcing users to stop, inspect and mentally solve a riddle transforms an everyday functional operation into an unnecessary point of friction.

Why it was designed like this: With nowadays's trend of modernizing everything and prioritizing brand identity, many designers over engineer a simple concept overturning its main purpose for a shot at clever design, in an attempt to make something simple feel innovative or playful

Suggested Corrections: It all comes down to keeping it simple. Like I said earlier, for the good design, we don't have to reinvent the wheel. Wayfinding is deeply ingrained in human intuition and societal habits, so forcing users to decode visual riddles for a basic need is counterproductive. Artistic flair and branding image can be kept but should not override and confuse users on performing simple tasks.